



Entered Together, Flagged Never

Classifying Contradictory Signal-Pairs and Tracking Their Ratification

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Background

Horizon Register entries are logged, scored, and forwarded to committee one at a time. Despite the register's growing entry volume, little is known about what happens when two contradictory signals arrive in the same scanning cycle and neither is ever asked to explain the other.

Aims

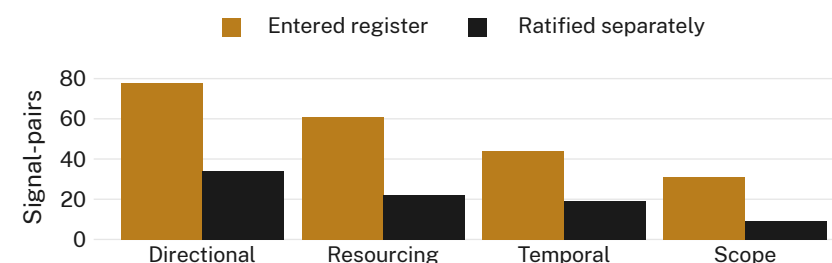
- Classify contradictory signal-pairs entering the register within a single scanning cycle into a working typology.
- Track the share of each type subsequently ratified by Futures in Committee as separate, standing priorities.
- Check whether the register's own fields ever record the contradiction before ratification proceeds.

Approach

- 214 contradictory signal-pairs · Horizon Register, 21 quarterly scanning cycles, 2020–2025
- typed against a four-category taxonomy (directional, resourcing, temporal, scope) by two independent coders; agreement $\kappa = 0.79$
- ratification cross-checked against Futures in Committee minutes; contradiction-flag field coded present/absent, no threshold adjusted post hoc

What we found

84 of the 214 pairs (39%) were ratified as two separate live priorities within two scanning cycles of first appearing; the register's own contradiction-flag field returned null for all 84.



Directional contradictions converted to separate live priorities at the highest rate of any type — 44% (34/78) across the 2020–2025 window — with a zero-flag record in every category.

Implications & where next

Contradiction is not the exception; it is the register's normal operating condition, and ratification proceeds signal by signal rather than pair by pair. Futures in Committee adjudicates each entry on its own merits and never the two together. Next: a mandatory co-occurrence check at first reading, before either signal reaches committee.

References

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Coding drawn from register metadata and public minutes only; no committee member identified or interviewed. Taxonomy thresholds fixed before ratification outcomes were consulted.

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“Both signals were ratified. Neither noticed the other.”

39% (84/214) of contradictory signal-pairs entering the Horizon Register together, 2020–2025, went on to become separate live priorities.